# Market Briefing — Friday, 17 July 2026 (SGT)

*Theme tracker initialized today (no prior note in the vault). Overnight: US & Europe Thu 16 Jul; Asia session opening — note Korea's exchange is closed today for Constitution Day.*

## 1. Executive Summary

1. **[PIVOTAL/BEARISH] TSMC beat and raised — and chips sold off anyway.** Record Q2 profit (+77% y/y) and a sharp 2026 capex guidance hike to $60–64bn (from $52–56bn), with management citing AI compute demand visible through 2029–2030. The stock still fell ~4%, dragging Micron, AMD, Lam and Intel lower, because the market read the capex raise as a capital-intensity and margin-dilution risk rather than a demand reassurance. (Investing.com, Reuters via Investing.com)
2. **[BEARISH RISK] The Iran war crossed into active blockade enforcement.** US Central Command used Hellfire missiles to disable the tanker M/T Belma for defying the reinstated naval blockade — the first forcible enforcement action — while Iran's Revolutionary Guard threatened to halt *all* Middle East energy exports, not just Hormuz-linked shipping. Brent is still only consolidating near $84–85. (NPR, NBC News)
3. **[HAWKISH-LEANING] New Fed Chair Warsh's first testimony signals an institutional overhaul, not a rate signal.** Kevin Warsh told Congress the Fed has "no tolerance for persistently elevated inflation" and unveiled five new internal task forces (communications, balance-sheet policy, data sources, AI/productivity, and the inflation framework itself). Resilient Thursday data (jobless claims at a 10-week low, a blowout Philly Fed print) nudged yields up and trimmed July hold odds slightly to ~89–90%. (Federal Reserve, Bank Policy Institute)
4. **[BEARISH] Netflix fell ~8% after hours on a free-cash-flow miss and a soft guide.** Q2 revenue and EPS were in line-to-slightly-better, but free cash flow dropped 33% y/y to $1.53bn (vs. $2.72bn expected) and Q3/FY guidance came in below Street on revenue growth and margin — the second disappointing guide of 2026. (Bloomberg, CNBC)
5. **[MIXED] Korea's memory rout deepened, but Asia diverged sharply.** The Bank of Korea delivered a surprise-scale 25bp hike (first since Jan 2023) the same day Kospi fell 6.37% and tripped its 37th circuit-breaker sidecar of the year (SK Hynix -11.5%, Samsung -8.8%) — yet Hang Seng rose 1.3–1.4% on a *different* story: China's approval of Apple Intelligence running on Alibaba/Baidu models. Meanwhile CXMT priced Asia's largest 2026 IPO ($8.6bn), turning China's memory ambitions into a public-market reality. (CNBC, Seoul Economic Daily)

## 2. Theme Tracker

*First edition — no prior briefing exists in the vault, so the tracker is initialized today with the four seed themes. Deltas from tomorrow.*

### fed-path — US Fed path & inflation — TURNING (hawkish-leaning)

- **What changed:** New Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's inaugural semiannual testimony (House 14 Jul, Senate 15 Jul) struck a vigilant tone — "no tolerance for persistently elevated inflation," and an explicit refusal to declare victory over June's softer CPI. He also announced five new internal task forces reviewing communications, balance-sheet policy, data sources, AI's effect on the economy, and the inflation framework itself — a genuine structural review, not routine housekeeping. Thursday's data reinforced the less-dovish tone: jobless claims fell to 208k (a 10-week low, beating consensus) and the Philly Fed index printed 41.4 versus a ~12–13 consensus, a large upside surprise. That partially reversed Wednesday's PPI-driven dovish move. July 28–29 FOMC hold odds sit around 89–90%, down from a brief mid-week peak near 95%.

- **Market effect:** 2Y yield +2bp to ~4.16%, 10Y +3bp to ~4.58%, DXY firmed to ~100.7. Equities fell Thursday but that move was chip-idiosyncratic, not rate-driven.
- **Concept:** A rate decision is one signal; task forces are another. When a new central-bank chief opens multiple internal reviews of the institution's own framework, it signals the reaction function itself may change over the coming year — a slower-moving but potentially larger repricing event than any single meeting's hold/hike call.

### hormuz-oil — Hormuz / oil shock — STRENGTHENING (military escalation, contained price action)

- **What changed:** The US and Iran traded fire for a sixth consecutive day. US Central Command disabled the tanker **M/T Belma** with Hellfire missiles for defying the reinstated naval blockade — the first forcible blockade-enforcement action of this conflict — while Iran retaliated against US bases in Kuwait and Jordan. Iran's Revolutionary Guard escalated its rhetoric further, threatening to halt *all* Middle East energy exports rather than only Hormuz-transiting cargo, and reports suggest the US is weighing options up to seizing Kharg Island (~90% of Iran's oil exports). Tanker war-risk insurance has risen to roughly 5% of vessel value (~$3–8m per large-tanker transit), a ~20x jump from the pre-war norm of ~0.25%.
- **Market effect:** Brent is only consolidating near $84–85, still well short of the conflict's ~$120 peak; OPEC+ still approved a token 188,000 bbl/d August output increase. Gold, oddly, *fell* roughly 2% and broke back below $4,000 — the dollar and rising real yields absorbed the safe-haven bid instead of bullion, a genuine gold-oil decoupling this week (more in Global Pulse below).
- **Concept:** War-risk insurance premiums are the market's own real-time probability estimate of tail risk, priced directly into shipping costs rather than into the spot oil price. A 20x jump in that premium — while Brent itself barely moves — tells you underwriters see meaningfully more danger than the crude market is pricing.

### ai-capex — AI capex cycle — TURNING (verdict arrived, and it's ambiguous)

- **What changed:** TSMC's Thursday earnings were meant to be the "referee" of the AI-capex debate. It delivered a record beat and *raised* 2026 capex guidance to $60–64bn from $52–56bn, with CEO C.C. Wei saying compute demand-supply gaps persist "through 2029–2030" and that CoWoS packaging capacity is "so tight it's limiting my customers' growth." The market punished the stock anyway (-4%), reading the capex raise as a margin/capital-intensity risk. Separately: Korea's Kospi fell 6.37% (SK Hynix -11.5%, Samsung -8.8%) on the same day the Bank of Korea delivered a surprise-scale 25bp hike; **CXMT** priced Asia's largest 2026 IPO at $8.6bn (see Deep Dive); Apple confirmed testing DRAM chips from CXMT and YMTC to plug a supply shortage that has already forced Mac/iPad price increases; and Alphabet fell over 4% on a report that Gemini 3.5 Pro is behind schedule — a crack in the AI product race, not just the capex numbers. Aggregate Big Tech 2026 capex guidance across the four largest hyperscalers now runs $650–725bn, up from ~$410bn in 2025.
- **Market effect:** Nasdaq -1.47% (worst of the majors) on Micron -5.5%, AMD -3.6%, Lam -3.6%, Intel -4%+; Nikkei -2.7–2.8% (Kioxia -15%). Hang Seng was the outlier, +1.3–1.4%, entirely on the separate Apple-Alibaba-Baidu AI-approval story.
- **Concept:** A capex *raise* can be read as bearish rather than bullish when it signals capital intensity (capex as a share of revenue) rising faster than revenue itself — that implies margin dilution and free-cash-flow compression even in a best-case demand scenario. Investors are increasingly discounting confirmed capital outlay against still-uncertain returns.

### bond-regime — Bond market regime — STABLE, modestly higher across the curve

- **What changed:** Thursday's resilient data (low claims, blowout Philly Fed) reversed part of Wednesday's PPI-driven rally — the whole curve backed up slightly (2Y +2bp, 10Y +3bp, 30Y +2bp to ~5.11%) rather than continuing to bull-steepen. Context from earlier this month: the 9 July 30-year Treasury auction drew the highest yield in roughly 20 years (5.058%), yet demand held up despite swelling supply concerns.
- **Market effect:** DXY firmed; gold fell as real yields ticked higher; the day's equity moves were chip-specific rather than rate-driven.
- **Concept:** The front end of the curve prices the Fed's near-term path; the long end prices the compensation investors demand for holding duration risk over decades (the term premium) plus long-run inflation expectations. A 30-year auction clearing at a 20-year-high yield — but still clearing — says the market will still buy US duration, just at a steadily rising price for the privilege.

## 3. Overnight Wrap

**US (Thu 16 Jul):** S&P 500 -0.51% to 7,533.77; Nasdaq -1.47% to 25,881.95; Dow -0.20% to 52,552.97. Chip-led weakness dominated (→ ai-capex); Alphabet fell over 4% on the Gemini 3.5 Pro delay report; UnitedHealth, Abbott and GE Aerospace earnings beats offset some of the drag. Netflix fell roughly 8% in after-hours trading on a free-cash-flow miss ($1.53bn vs. $2.72bn expected) and a below-Street Q3/FY guide — its second disappointing guide this year, and a standalone story outside the four running themes. (TheStreet, Bloomberg)

**Europe:** Stoxx 600 +0.16% to 643.73 (+0.41% week-to-date) — resilient despite Mideast tension. Media led (+1.43%); basic resources lagged (-1.38%); STMicroelectronics and BE Semiconductor fell 2–3% on chip-sector contagion from the TSMC reaction and SK Hynix's overnight ADR slide. (Investing.com)

**Rates & FX:** 2Y ~4.16%, 10Y ~4.58%, 30Y ~5.11% (→ bond-regime). DXY firmed to ~100.7; USD/SGD roughly flat near 1.2904.

## 4. Asia Day-Ahead

**Korea is dark today:** the Korea Exchange is closed for Constitution Day, so Thursday's 6.37% Kospi close (6,820.60) stands as the reference point until Monday's reopen — the next live test of whether the memory rout stabilizes comes with Samsung's earnings (23 Jul) and SK Hynix's (29 Jul). The Bank of Korea's surprise-scale 25bp hike to 2.75% — its first since January 2023, delivered unanimously and citing 3.2% CPI and a won that's weakened roughly 5% year-to-date to its softest level since the 2008 financial crisis — landed the same day as the chip crash and, if anything, amplified rather than calmed it. Governor Shin Hyun-song flagged the semiconductor *price*, not the semiconductor *share price*, as the thing to actually watch.

**Rest of the region:** Nikkei fell 2.7–2.8% Thursday (Kioxia -15%) and looks set to extend losses after Wall Street's chip-led overnight drop; Hang Seng was the regional outlier, +1.3–1.4% on the Apple-Alibaba-Baidu AI-approval story; Shanghai Composite fell 1.85% to a three-month low (3,882).

**Singapore angle:** STI touched fresh record territory this week — a record close of 5,469 on 13 July and an intraday high near 5,561 on 15 July, both driven by the local banks (DBS briefly crossed S$70) — before easing to ~5,521 Thursday (-0.69%) as regional chip-sector jitters and Middle East tension capped further gains. The index remains close to record levels, consistent with its role as a relative safe haven within Asia this year: bank-heavy, defensive, no direct chip exposure. **USD/SGD ~1.2904**, broadly flat; MAS's next quarterly Monetary Policy Statement hasn't been issued yet in July (economist surveys expect a hold, pending clarity on second-round inflation effects from elevated oil), so no fresh policy signal is due imminently. **June NODX** (non-oil domestic exports) is embargoed until 8:30am SGT today and had not yet posted at file time — May's actual was a 20-year-record +38.4% y/y (electronics NODX +94.8% on AI demand); consensus for June points to growth moderating to roughly 25–30% y/y, which would still be a fourth straight month of double-digit growth. Worth a same-day check once the release lands.

**Next 24h (US):** a relatively light data calendar into the weekend — the market's focus shifts toward Big Tech's Q2 earnings season, which opens next week with Alphabet on 22 July, now carrying extra scrutiny after Thursday's Gemini-delay-driven selloff.

## 5. Deep Dive — CXMT's $8.6bn IPO Turns China's Memory Threat Into a Priced Reality

**What happened:** ChangXin Memory Technologies priced its Shanghai STAR Market IPO at 8.66 yuan/share, raising roughly RMB57.9bn (~$8.55bn, up to ~$8.6bn with over-allotment) — Asia's largest IPO of 2026 and the biggest-ever A-share semiconductor listing. Trading begins Monday 27 July. CXMT is already the world's fourth-largest DRAM maker by 2025 market share (~7.7%), with Q1 2026 revenue up 719% y/y to RMB50.8bn. Of the net proceeds, 69.5% funds wafer-line and DRAM technology upgrades and 30.5% funds forward DRAM R&D, including a build-out of HBM (high-bandwidth memory) capacity from roughly 5,000 wafers/month today to ~30,000 by end-2026 and ~55,000 by 2027. (Bloomberg, SemiAnalysis)

**Why it matters:** For weeks, "Chinese memory oversupply" has been an overhang narrative behind the Korean chip selloff. This IPO converts that narrative into a concrete, dated, capitalized entity that public markets will now price directly against Samsung, SK Hynix and Micron — and the $8.55bn raise materially accelerates the very capacity build Korean and US memory makers fear. It also connects directly to two other threads in this briefing: CXMT (along with YMTC) is one of the suppliers Apple has reportedly been testing DRAM from to plug a chip shortage that has already pushed up Mac and iPad prices, and the IPO pricing itself was cited as a direct contributor to Micron's roughly 7% drop on 15 July, one trading day before the broader Kospi rout.

**What's priced:** A good chunk of the fear is already in Micron and SK Hynix's share prices after this week's selloff. *Not* priced: whether CXMT's HBM ramp actually hits its stated timeline (30,000 wafers/month by end-2026 is an aggressive scale-up), whether Beijing extends further subsidy or protection, and whether reported US deliberations over tighter unilateral HBM export restrictions turn into an actual rule — so far that's second-hand reporting of a deliberation, not a confirmed BIS action.

**Monitor:** CXMT's 27 July trading debut and where it settles relative to Samsung/SK Hynix/Micron multiples; Samsung's 23 July and SK Hynix's 29 July earnings for HBM pricing and capacity-commitment language; any confirmed US export-control move on HBM technology.

## Global Pulse

**(a) EM & international snapshot:** This week's dominant EM story is Korea's won, whipsawed by the Kospi crash and the BOK's surprise-scale hike; the currency remains roughly 5% weaker year-to-date, its softest level since the 2008 financial crisis, despite the hike. Elsewhere the picture is mixed rather than uniformly risk-off: the Brazilian real is holding up near 5.10–5.13/USD on high carry (Selic cut to 14.25% in June but with an explicitly restrictive tone); the Mexican peso slipped 0.34% Thursday alone, eating into six weeks of carry-trade gains as the dollar firmed; the Indonesian rupiah firmed modestly but remains roughly 10% weaker year-on-year even after 100bp of Bank Indonesia hikes; the South African rand weakened to ~16.33–16.40/USD on dollar strength ahead of a 23 July SARB decision flagged as hawkish-leaning; the Turkish lira continued its steady grind to ~46.7–47.0/USD with the CBRT holding at 37%. The Indian rupee was the week's clear underperformer (see below). EM credit stayed historically tight — the JPM EMBI Global Core spread sits near 168.6bp after a 53bp tightening move in Q2 — and EM bond fund inflows were healthy in Q2 ($9.0bn hard-currency, $4.5bn local-currency), even as EM equity fund flows turned choppier into July, a genuine divergence from BofA's July Fund Manager Survey showing the most bullish global sentiment since February.

**(b) Economy in focus — India:** June CPI accelerated to 4.38% y/y, breaking above the RBI's 4% target for the first time in 17 months, driven by a combination of oil-price pass-through from the Iran war and India's fifth-driest June since 1901 (rainfall 39.8% below normal), which sent food inflation to 5.32% (ginger +50% y/y, tomatoes +32% y/y). The rupee touched an all-time low near 96.84/USD, with the RBI reportedly intervening via spot and forward dollar sales; 2026 year-to-date FII equity outflows (~$27bn) already exceed all of 2025, and RBI reserves have fallen from ~$728bn to ~$682bn. The Sensex and Nifty each fell roughly 0.7% on 14 July as autos, financials and realty led declines. The RBI has revised its FY27 inflation forecast up from 4.6% to 5.1%, and where consensus had expected a hold or cut, some economists now flag a possible August hike — a textbook case of an oil-importing, current-account-deficit economy absorbing a geopolitical energy shock and a domestic weather shock simultaneously, forcing a central bank into a much more hawkish reaction function than anyone expected a month ago. (Bloomberg, Business Recorder)

**(c) Cross-asset signal of the week — the gold-oil decoupling:** Brent rose roughly 9% over the week (about 19% since the conflict's February start) to a one-month high near $85–87, while gold *fell* roughly 3% over the same days, breaking back below $4,000 for a third session. Normally both rally together during a Middle East escalation, as both are treated as hedges against physical disruption and macro uncertainty. This week they split: the dollar (DXY firm near 100.6–101.4) absorbed the safe-haven bid instead of bullion, and rising real yields (10Y toward ~4.60%) pressured non-yielding gold directly. The read: markets currently treat the Iran war as a contained, tradeable commodity-supply event rather than a systemic risk-off trigger — and the resulting combination of rising oil, rising yields and a firm dollar simultaneously tightens financial conditions for oil-importing emerging markets like India and Turkey through both the terms-of-trade channel (costlier imported oil) and the financing channel (a stronger dollar makes dollar-denominated debt costlier to service).

## 6. Idea Lab — Netflix (NFLX)

*Learning exercise, not a recommendation. Chosen as today's single biggest company-specific mover and the clearest rotation away from this week's chip-heavy tape.*

**How it makes money:** Subscription streaming still generates the large majority of revenue, layered with a fast-growing ad-supported tier. The core unit economics are a race between content amortization (Netflix expenses content costs over time, not all upfront) and subscriber ARPU (average revenue per user); the ad tier adds a second, still-maturing monetization layer priced per-member on top of subscription revenue. Three KPIs matter most: (1) **operating margin trajectory** — 33.4% in Q2, guided down slightly to 33.2% for Q3 and 31.5% for the full year, meaning the business is deliberately trading near-term margin for content and ad-infrastructure investment; (2) **free cash flow conversion** — the number that actually moved the stock, down 33% y/y to $1.53bn against a $2.72bn Street estimate; (3) **revenue growth guide** — 12% y/y for Q3 (11% FX-neutral), decelerating from the growth rates Netflix posted through the password-sharing crackdown and price-hike cycle.

- **Bull in one line:** Ad-tier scaling and password-sharing monetization are still early innings, and a single quarter's FCF miss — plausibly just content-spend timing — doesn't erase a content-to-subscriber flywheel that remains structurally ahead of every other streamer's.
- **Bear in one line:** Margin and FCF guidance have both stepped down for a second straight quarter even as growth decelerates into low double digits, suggesting the easy wins (price increases, crackdown monetization)

are exhausted and the business is reverting to a heavier-capex media company.

**Differentiating question:** Is the free-cash-flow shortfall a timing issue — content spend front-loaded into the first half of 2026 that reverses in the second half — or a structural step-down in cash conversion as ad-tier infrastructure and live/sports content require sustained higher spending? The H2 FCF cadence, not the headline revenue growth number, is what will actually settle this.

## 7. Trade Floor — Two Open Tensions

**Equity — TSMC beat and raised. So why did chip stocks fall?** One side: raising 2026 capex to $60–64bn while saying the demand-supply gap for compute persists through 2029–2030, and that CoWoS packaging capacity is "so tight it's limiting my customers' growth," is about as bullish a demand signal as a foundry can give — Thursday's selloff is a knee-jerk capital-intensity scare that fades once Q3 numbers land. Other side: capex is rising faster than even TSMC's own raised revenue guide (~40% y/y revenue growth against a much larger step-up in spending), which squeezes free cash flow and margins even in the best-case demand scenario — and with Meta signaling capex discipline and the Bank of Korea now actively tightening into this capital cycle, financial conditions for the whole memory/AI complex are getting less accommodative just as spending peaks. *Settling datapoint: Samsung's 23 July and SK Hynix's 29 July earnings — do they report HBM pricing holding or cracking, and do they raise or trim their own capex plans in response to TSMC's move?*

**FICC/oil — Is Brent's ~$85 handle underpricing an active US-Iran war?** One side: this week crossed a real threshold — the US used lethal force to physically disable a tanker for defying the blockade, and Iran is now threatening to halt not just Hormuz-linked but *all* Middle East energy exports; war-risk insurance at roughly 5% of vessel value (a ~20x jump from pre-war levels) says underwriters see real tail risk that the spot oil price doesn't reflect. Other side: actual flows haven't broken — roughly 9.2 million barrels have moved since the ceasefire collapsed on 8 July, OPEC+ still added supply for August, and gold — the other classic geopolitical hedge — is falling, not rising, suggesting markets genuinely read this as a contained, tradeable supply event rather than a systemic shock. *Settling datapoint: daily Hormuz transit volumes and war-risk insurance premiums over the coming week — a further insurance spike alongside falling transit counts would say the tail risk is being underpriced.*

## 8. Radar

- **Samsung Electronics Q2 earnings, 23 July** — the first major post-rout read on whether HBM/DRAM pricing is holding; preliminary guidance has already flagged a roughly 18x y/y profit surge.
- **CXMT's Shanghai STAR Market trading debut, 27 July** — watch the opening valuation multiple against Samsung/SK Hynix/Micron as a live gauge of how public markets price China's memory ambitions.
- **SK Hynix earnings call, 29 July**, the same week as the FOMC — HBM capacity-commitment language is the cleanest available signal on whether 2027 supply agreements are take-or-pay or volume-flexible.
- **Lam Research (29 July) and KLA Corp (30 July)** — wafer-fab-equipment order books are a leading indicator of hyperscaler and foundry capex intentions, reporting well before Nvidia's own print.
- **The Fed's five new internal task forces**, unveiled in Warsh's 14 July testimony (communications, balance-sheet policy, data sources, AI/productivity, and the inflation framework) — early staffing news or terms-of-reference would be a genuine scoop on the Fed's future reaction function under new leadership.

## 9. Catalyst Calendar

| Date (SGT) | Event | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Fri 17 Jul | Singapore June NODX release; US House hearing on the CLARITY Act (digital-asset market structure) | Electronics-export momentum read; crypto regulatory clarity |
| Tue 21 Jul | Tesla Q2 earnings | EV demand and margin signal |
| Wed 22 Jul | Alphabet/Google Q2 earnings; Texas Instruments Q2 earnings (after close) | Gemini-delay scrutiny meets the numbers; TXN as an analog/industrial capex bellwether |
| Thu 23 Jul | ECB rate decision; Samsung Electronics Q2 earnings | Eurozone policy path; first major post-rout HBM/DRAM pricing read |
| Fri 24 Jul | Section 122 global tariff (10% import surcharge) statutory expiration | Watch for a replacement Section 301 action; tariff overhang for Apple/Amazon/Meta reporting the same week |
| Mon 27 Jul | CXMT Shanghai STAR Market trading debut | China's memory self-sufficiency priced live |
| Tue–Wed 28–29 Jul | FOMC meeting and decision (Wed 2pm ET) | ~89% odds of a hold; Warsh's first FOMC as chair |
| Wed 29 Jul | Meta Platforms, SK Hynix, Lam Research earnings | Capex discipline vs. HBM demand vs. WFE order books, all in the same week as the Fed |
| Thu 30 Jul | Apple, Amazon, KLA Corp earnings | Tariff and China-sourcing commentary; WFE read-through completes |
| Fri 31 Jul | Bank of Japan rate decision | Next policy signal after June's 25bp hike |

## 10. Market Dashboard

| Asset | Level | Change | Driver |
|---|---|---|---|
| S&P 500 | 7,533.77 | -0.51% | Chip-led pullback despite solid earnings tape |
| Nasdaq Composite | 25,881.95 | -1.47% | Memory/chip selloff plus Alphabet -4%+ on Gemini 3.5 delay report |
| STI | ~5,521 | -0.69% | Pulling back from record highs on regional chip-sector contagion |
| US 10-Year Treasury | ~4.58% | +3bp | Resilient claims/Philly Fed data offsets Wednesday's dovish PPI move |
| DXY | ~100.7 | +0.2% | Broad dollar firmness; absorbing safe-haven demand instead of gold |
| USD/SGD | 1.2904 | ~flat | Tracking DXY; MAS's July policy statement still pending |
| Brent Crude | ~$84.7 | -0.3% | Consolidating near one-month highs amid active Hormuz blockade enforcement |
| Gold | ~$3,992 | -1.5% to -2% | Dollar/real-yield channel dominating over safe-haven bid; broke below $4,000 |
| Bitcoin | ~$64,700 | ~flat | Soft mid-week CPI supportive; ETF inflows resumed after a 10-day outflow streak |
| VIX | ~16.7 | +7% | Chip-sector vol spike; still a historically low, non-panic level |

## 11. Journal Seed

The sharpest thing to form a view on today is the TSMC reaction: a record beat, a raised capex guide, and management explicitly saying AI compute demand outstrips supply through 2029–2030 — and the stock still fell. That's not a data problem, it's a valuation-psychology problem, and it's testable against real data within two weeks (Samsung on 23 July, SK Hynix on 29 July).

> *If TSMC's own management says demand exceeds supply for the next four years, and the stock falls anyway on a capex raise — is the market correctly repricing capital intensity and margin risk, or pattern-matching to past capex cycles that never operated at this scale? What single data point from Samsung's or SK Hynix's upcoming earnings would actually change your mind?*